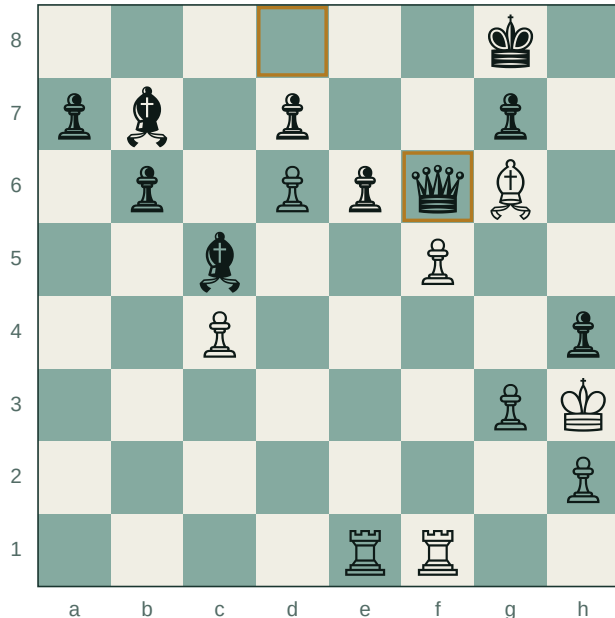


Promotion combinations: White, move 38

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. fxe6 Qxg6 39. exd7 Qxd6 40. Re8+ Kh7 41. d8=Q Qxd8 42. Rxd8

38.fxe6 The pawn captures the pawn on e6. The changed line means the rook on f1 attacks the queen on f6. Recorded reply: **38...Qxg6**.

39.exd7 The pawn captures the pawn on d7. Recorded reply: **39...Qxd6**.

40.Re8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **40...Kh7**.

41.d8=Q The pawn moves from d7 to d8. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **41...Qxd8**.

42.Rxd8 The rook captures the queen on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7. Check for tactical protection.